The week ahead: the ECB on Thursday, then US CPI

Written on Monday 7 September 2026, before the 11:00 CET Eurostat release. It lists the week's key scheduled releases and sets thresholds for the ECB decision, using only what was public by then.

ECB DECISION
Thu 10 Sep
14:15 CET, press conference 14:45

BASE CASE
+25bp
deposit rate 2.25% to 2.50%

US CPI, AUGUST
Fri 11 Sep
July: 3.4% y/y

EUR/USD
1.1622
ECB reference rate, 4 Sep

01 The week's key releases

DAY	TIME	EVENT	PREVIOUS
MON 7	11:00 CET	Euro area GDP and employment, Q2 (Eurostat)	Flash: GDP +0.4% q/q, +1.0% y/y; employment +0.1% q/q
THU 10	08:00 Oslo	Norway CPI, August (Statistics Norway)	July: CPI 3.0% y/y; CPI-ATE 2.7% y/y
THU 10	**14:15 CET**	ECB monetary policy decision; press conference 14:45 CET	Deposit rate now 2.25%
THU 10	08:30 ET	US Producer Price Index, August (BLS)	July: 0.0% m/m, +4.7% y/y
FRI 11	08:30 ET	US Consumer Price Index, August (BLS)	July: +0.1% m/m, 3.4% y/y; core +0.2% m/m, 2.5% y/y

Times are as each publisher states them. "Previous" is the first published figure for the prior period. No forecasts are shown: the official sources do not publish them and no public consensus was used. Monday is Labor Day in the US, so BLS publishes nothing that day. Tuesday and Wednesday carry no key release on the calendars checked; the Governing Council meets on Wednesday and Thursday.

Thursday is the crowded day. The ECB decides at 14:15 CET, the ECB's label for Frankfurt local time. US PPI follows at 08:30 ET, which is 14:30 in Frankfurt in September. So the first read of EUR/USD after the decision will also carry the dollar's reaction to PPI, fifteen minutes later.

Friday's US CPI is the second main event. It gives the dollar its own driver, so a quiet euro on Thursday can still move on Friday for reasons that have nothing to do with the ECB.

02 The ECB on Thursday, in depth

What is decided. Whether to change the three key rates, what the new staff projections show, and whether the guidance sentence changes. Rates now: deposit 2.25%, main refinancing 2.40%, marginal lending 2.65%, in force since 17 June. The guidance has not changed since June: data dependent, meeting by meeting, and "not pre-committing to a particular rate path".

What the public record expects. The account of the July meeting, published 27 August, says a September hike was "almost fully priced in" at the time of that meeting, and the Survey of Monetary Analysts saw one more hike in 2026. On 2 September, Bundesbank President Nagel said markets priced a more than 95% probability of a September hike, so a 25 basis point hike is the base case here. The August HICP flash was 3.3% (core 2.4%), up from 2.9% in July.

JUNE STAFF PROJECTIONS: THE REFERENCE FOR THE THRESHOLDS BELOW

ANNUAL AVERAGE, %	2026	2027	2028
Headline HICP	3.0	2.3	2.0
HICP excluding energy and food	2.5	2.5	2.2
GDP growth	0.8	1.2	1.5

Highlighted cells feed the thresholds. Source: ECB press release, 11 June 2026.

SCENARIO THRESHOLDS

SIGNAL	A: STRONGER EURO	C: IN BETWEEN	B: WEAKER EURO
Rate move	More than 25bp	25bp	Hold
Guidance wording	Points to another hike	June sentence unchanged	Signals a pause
2027 headline HICP June: 2.3%	2.5% or higher	2.2% to 2.4%	2.1% or lower
2027 core HICP June: 2.5%	2.7% or higher	2.4% to 2.6%	2.3% or lower
GDP 2026 or 2027 June: 0.8% and 1.2%	Either raised by 0.2 points or more	Both within 0.1 points	Either cut by 0.2 points or more

How to read it: a rate move or guidance wording in column A or B decides the scenario on its own. With 25bp and unchanged wording, it takes two projection rows in the same outer column to call A or B. Anything else is C.

SCENARIO C, THE BASE CASE

A 25bp hike with no new signal. With the hike expected, I would expect little follow-through in EUR/USD from the decision itself, and the pair to take its next cue from US PPI on Thursday and US CPI on Friday.

WHAT WOULD CHANGE MY MIND

If today's Eurostat release revises Q2 GDP growth to 0.2% q/q or less, from the 0.4% flash, I would treat a hold or a pause signal as a live alternative. Otherwise the base case stands.

03 The other events in short

US PPI, August

THU 10 SEP, 08:30 ET

July final demand prices were unchanged on the month and up 4.7% on the year. Excluding foods, energy and trade services they rose 0.4% (4.7% y/y). A print above July would point to cost pressure still building; below would ease it.

Norway CPI, August

THU 10 SEP, 08:00 OSLO

July CPI was 3.0% y/y and CPI-ATE, adjusted for tax changes and excluding energy, was 2.7%. Both were 2.7% in June. CPI-ATE is the cleaner trend measure, so it is the line to check first.

US CPI, August

FRI 11 SEP, 08:30 ET

July headline rose 0.1% m/m (3.4% y/y) after a 0.4% fall in June; core rose 0.2% (2.5% y/y). Core above 0.2% m/m or headline above 3.4% y/y would read as firmer; at or below both, as cooling.

Marks are set against the previous release because no public forecast was used.

04 How positioning shapes the scenarios

Leveraged funds were net short 38,173 euro futures on 1 September, 4.4% of open interest, and 27,025 contracts smaller than at the 28 July extreme (CFTC report of 4 September; positions lag by days). That is a mild short, not a crowded one. Scenario C leaves little positioning to unwind. Scenarios A and B would land on a position with room to move either way.

> THREAD: It is Thursday morning and the decision is hours away. How did things look just before it? Next: the morning brief.

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